Defence to the Air Force. Once again, rather than operational considerations, HR issues came to the fore and started becoming the hidden agenda behind any recommendations. To really be able to arrive at a pragmatic model, we need to divorce the Theatre Command from the Theatre Commander. The Theatre Commander will be appointed by the government, from the available tri-service pool of officers, over which the Services would have no jurisdiction. The same is the case for the appointment of the CDS, who could be from any Service. To legislate that these appointments should be rotational among the Services or in any particular ratio just amounts to wanting to protect one's turf.

As far as the Army was concerned, the plan was to nominate HQ South Western Command to become the LTC (W) with the Western and Southern Commands under it. The operational area of SWC would be divided between WC and SC. HQ Central Command was nominated as LTC (N) with the Central Sector and Eastern Command under it. Northern Command was left out for the time being. Accordingly, the two Army Commanders, Lt Gen AS Bhinder and Lt Gen Yogendra Dimri were tasked to carry this plan forward and suggest an organogram for their respective theatres. This they did and presented their models to the MO Dte. It became immediately obvious that each Theatre would have to be tailor-made to suit its role and peculiar terrain and climatic conditions. Therefore, it was equally obvious that the role and area of responsibility of the proposed Theatres first needed to be spelt out and only then could an assessment of forces required to carry out that role be arrived at. In the Ends-Ways-Means construct, the Theatre Commander must know what are the Means (forces) at his disposal, before considering the Ways of how to apply them, in order to achieve the Ends set out for the Theatre. This

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